Teaching Heart to Heart: Equip your disciplers to have time in the Word with God that grows their faith.

Even little ones can learn BIG truths about our wonderful Savior!

LESSON 10

God Reached Out in Love

show me Jesus

HEART PREPARATION

Adam and Eve's perfect fellowship with God was broken when they disobeyed him, and God's image in them was marred. In their guilt and shame, Adam and Eve hid from God. But God did not stop loving them. He reached out to them in his mercy, calling them to account for their sin and announcing a plan for restoring his people to himself. Genesis 3:15 states:

> "I will put enmity between you and the woman, and between your offspring and her offspring; he shall bruise your head, and you shall bruise his heel."

Now in English Standard Version (ESV) Bible translation

God said that the serpent, Satan, would be destroyed—defeated totally by the seed of the woman, Jesus, who would come one day. Just as God shed the blood of an animal to provide skins to cover Adam and Eve, one day the blood of his Son would be shed as the final sacrifice for sin (Gen. 3:21). Because of Jesus Christ's perfect obedience and his atoning sacrifice, God's people are restored to God, and creation can be made whole again. Jesus, in God's covenant of grace, restored what Adam had lost (Rom. 5:6–19).

What does this mean for children? Explain that, because of Adam's sin, we are all sinners, and we cannot fix the problem ourselves. We need a remedy. Right in the midst of all the sad things that happened in the garden, God promised to send a Savior. God kept his promise when he sent Jesus.

Explain that the Lord Jesus Christ is our Savior. He took the punishment for our sins so that we can be forgiven. Now we can trust Jesus to give us new hearts that want to love and serve God.

> "**Before His glorious victory,** the woman's seed must suffer to win the new community from the serpent's dominion. The suffering Christ is victorious. He has already won the victory at the cross by providing atonement for the saints and will consummate it at His second coming."
>
> *Reformation Study Bible,* p. 19

Bible Truth
Even while declaring his judgment against sin, God revealed a merciful plan to reconcile sinners to himself.

Scripture
Genesis 3

Lesson Focus
God promised to send a Savior who would pay for Adam and Eve's sin—and our sin.

Goals for the Children

- Name two ways God reached out in mercy to Adam and Eve.
- Tell who are sinners.
- Tell why we need someone to pay for our sins.
- Thank God for his promise to send a Savior.

Bible Verse Review
Exodus 20:8, John 15:14, 1 John 5:17

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Easy step-by-step plans and flexible for all settings

LESSON TEN AT A GLANCE

Steps & Minutes	Children's Activities	Supplies
1 Welcome > **5–10** minutes	Tell the story of *Brown Bear* to prepare for Bible Time.	☐ Brown teddy bear
2 Bible Time > **10–15** minutes	Hear the story of Adam and Eve's fall into sin and how God reached out in love.	☐ TA 10 Promised Redeemer* ☐ Bible, quilt, bag
3 Talk Time > **5–10** minutes	Focus on lesson truths.	
4 Sing, Make, & Do > **15–20** minutes	• Sing an action song. • Make an Adam & Eve puppet and use it to tell the Bible story. • Review **Exodus 20:8, John 15:14,** and **1 John 5:17.** • Complete *Let's Do 10.*	☐ SA 10 Adam & Eve sticker puppet** ☐ Plastic straws, paper punch ☐ SA 7a, SA 8, SA 9a big badges** ☐ *Let's Do 10*** ☐ Crayons, pencils
5 Final Focus > **5** minutes	Talk about God's remedy for guilt and sin. Pray together.	

TOTAL TIME: **40–60 MINUTES**

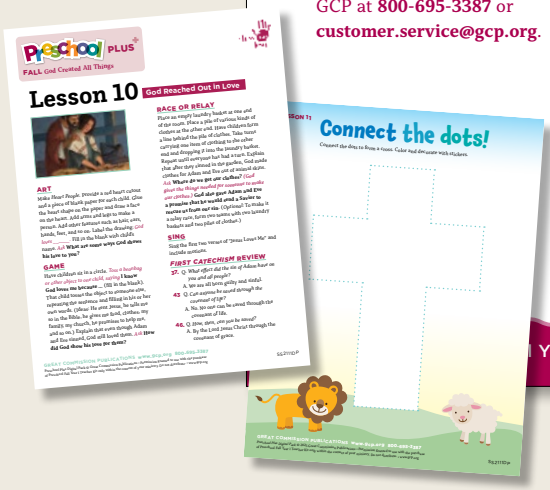
**Teaching Aids Pack* ***Student Activities Pack*

PRACTICAL PREP

- Read and meditate on Genesis 3 this week. Use the three pictures in TA 10 Promised Redeemer to practice telling the Bible story.
- For Welcome, bring a small brown teddy bear.
- For Let's Sing, practice the action song from Optional Activities (p. 73).
- For Let's Recite, gather the SA 7a Exodus 20:8, SA 8 John 15:14, and SA 9a 1 John 5:17 big badges to review previous Bible verses.
- For Let's Make, gather the SA 10 Adam & Eve sticker puppet (found on the sticker sheet with SA 2b, SA 3b, SA 10). You will also need plastic straws and glue sticks.
- Gather *Let's Do 10* papers for the class.
- As you get ready to teach, be sure you have all supplies needed on hand. Plan to be in your classroom ahead of time. Greet early arrivals and choose activities that fit in your time period.

Preschool Plus digital downloadable activities, games, and songs for extended time, children's church, and more!

Lots of Extra Activities!
Don't forget that the **Preschool Plus** digital extras has a lot of extra printables, sensory activities, games, family connections, and more. If you need help accessing it, contact GCP at **800-695-3387** or **customer.service@gcp.org**.



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Sparking Wonder: Start each lesson with fun, hands-on activities to engage preschoolers' imaginations

Every lesson includes optional activities to meet a variety of learning styles

1 WELCOME

5–10 minutes

Before the children arrive, hide a small brown teddy bear somewhere in the room. Tell the following story about a little brown bear.

One there was a little brown bear who did not clean his room. His mother told him to clean it up nicely while she was gone.

Instead of doing just that, Brown Bear decided to play in the forest! He danced in the sun, he fanned himself with leaves, and he ate honey to his heart's content.

By and by, Brown Bear's mother came down the forest path. *Ask* **How do you think Brown Bear felt when he saw her coming?** ***(scared, sorry)***

Brown Bear stopped playing and eating, and then he decided to do another wrong thing. He decided to run away. He hid from his mother.

"That way," he said to himself, "she can't find me and I won't be in trouble for not cleaning my room like she told me to do."

Off he went, scampering through the bushes and trees, away from his mother. But his mother had a very keen sense of smell. Would she find her Brown Bear?

Say **Brown Bear is hiding somewhere in the classroom. You may go and find him.** Have the children look for the bear.

When found, hold up the bear and say **I am glad that we found the Brown Bear.** *Ask* **Why did Brown Bear hide?** ***(because he did something wrong and was afraid he would be in trouble)***

Our story about Brown Bear is a *pretend* story. Now we are going to hear a true story from God's Word. It is about two people who did something wrong and tried to hide from God. Put away the teddy bear.

Optional Activities

- Play a version of *Hide and Seek*. Place two play people for Adam and Eve on the floor under two paper plates. Hide small play animals and trees under more paper plates. They will play a game to remember what God made. Have a child remove one plate, identify the item underneath it, and continue in this way.
- Sing the following words to the tune "Did You Ever See a Lassie?" Walk around in a circle and clap rhythmically while singing.

  Did you know God made a promise?
  A promise, a promise?

  Did you know God made a promise?
  To save us from sin.

Transition to Bible Time

2 BIBLE TIME

10–15 minutes

Interactive storytelling, illustrations, and props that bring Scripture to life

Keep your Bible open to Genesis 3. You will first summarize last week's story and then teach God's plan to rescue sinners.

At first, Adam and Eve were perfect and happy in the garden God made. Whenever they became hungry, they could eat from all the trees around them, except one. God told them not to eat from the tree of the knowledge of good and evil that was growing in the middle of the garden.

But God shows his love for us in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us. Romans 5:8

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New engaging illustrations to draw children into the world of the Bible

But Satan, the enemy of God, visited the garden and tempted Eve to eat the forbidden fruit. Eve didn't believe God's words about not eating of this tree and that they would die if they did. Instead, she listened to Satan's lies and ate the fruit they were not supposed to eat from this tree. She gave some to Adam and he ate it, too.

How sad! Adam and Eve had disobeyed God's command. God had been so good to them, giving them every wonderful thing they needed, but they foolishly disobeyed him. Now, instead of being holy and happy, Adam and Eve were sinful and miserable. They began to feel afraid and ashamed and tried to cover themselves with leaves and hide from God among the trees.

But they could not cover the sin that came into their hearts when they disobeyed God, and they certainly could not hide from God. God sees every person all the time. No one can hide from him, including Adam and Eve.

God loved Adam and Eve. He found them among the trees in the garden. God told them that because of their sin, their lives would be much harder than they had been before. And, like he had warned them before, he said one day they would die.

But God showed his mercy and great care for them in two very wonderful ways. They had tried to cover themselves with leaves, but God had another plan. First, he killed an animal for skins to make clothes that would protect and cover them. *Show TA 10, panel 1, Adam and Eve in animal skins.* Second, and even more important, he made a promise to take care of their sin.

Hold up your Bible and point to Genesis 3:15. God promised that one day he would send a child from Eve's family who would defeat the devil. He would make a way for Adam and Eve to be forgiven for their sin.

Now Adam and Eve did not know who the Savior would be or when he would come. But they trusted God's promise.

Do we know now who that Savior is? Yes, it is God's own Son, the Lord Jesus Christ. God sent Jesus to earth to pay for the sins of *any person* who trusts in him.

God sent Jesus to earth to be born as a baby. *Show TA 10, panel 2, the manger scene.* Jesus grew from a tiny baby to a man. He obeyed God perfectly and took the punishment we all deserve for our sin when he died on the cross. *Show TA 10, panel 3, the picture of the cross.* He died for the sins of Adam and Eve. He died for the sins of all God's people who would trust Jesus as their Savior.

It is wonderful to know that God had a plan to save his people—you and me—from their sins. He made a promise to send a Savior, and he kept his promise. Now we can trust Christ to save us from our sins. When we do, God forgives us. He gives us clean hearts that are able to trust and love him.

Discovering Jesus: In every lesson, preschoolers are pointed to Jesus

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Open-ended questions and discussions to help kids reflect and apply God's truth

3 TALK TIME

5–10 minutes

Ask the questions below:

- **What two ways did God show his love for Adam and Eve after they sinned?** *(clothed them in animal skins; promised to send a Savior)*
- **Who is a sinner?** *(everyone is a sinner; we are all sinners and need a Savior)*
- **Why do we need a Savior?** *(Explain in simple terms that everyone is born guilty and sinful because of Adam's sin. We cannot clean ourselves up from our sin. Jesus came to take care of all our sin—all our wrongdoing. He died on the cross and paid for our sins. If we trust in Jesus to forgive our sins, he saves us and forgives all our sin.)*

Use *First Catechism* Q/A 37, 43–46 to help the children's understanding of today's lesson truths and to focus on meeting lesson goals.

Q 37: **What effect did the sin of Adam have on you and all people?**
A: *We are all born guilty and sinful.*
Q 43: **Can anyone be saved through the covenant of life?**
A: *No. No one can be saved through the covenant of life.*
Q 44: **Why can't anyone be saved through covenant of life?**
A: *Because all have broken it and are condemned by it.*
Q 45: **How did you break the covenant of life?**
A: *Adam represented all people, and so I fell with Adam in his first sin.*
Q 46: **How, then, can you be saved?**
A: *By the Lord Jesus Christ through the covenant of grace.*

First Catechism is a great way to teach big Bible truths using simple Q/A

Teaching Tip
State the question and the answer, then repeat the question and have children repeat the answer phrase by phrase.

4 SING, MAKE, & DO

15–20 minutes

Let's Sing

Sing the action song from Optional Activities (p. 73). Let the children move around the room and do actions as they sing.

Let's Make

Show the class how to punch or cut out the SA 10 Adam & Eve sticker puppet from the sticker sheet. Sandwich a plastic straw between the front and back of Adam and Eve and paste together. Each child can hold the bottom part of the straw and use the puppet to tell the story of Adam and Eve.

You may want to have volunteers help your children make the puppet.

SA 2b, SA 3b, SA 10 sticker sheet

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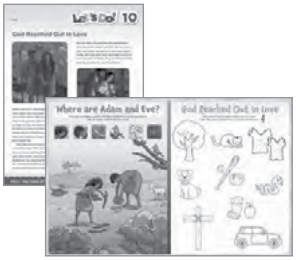
Preschoolers learn through play, drawing, and hands-on activities

Store up God's Word in little hearts by reciting Scripture in every lesson

Let's Recite

Use the big badges to say the verses Exodus 20:8, John 15:14, and 1 John 5:17 (SA 7a, SA 8, SA 9a) with the children. *Emphasize* **Jesus forgives our sin when we trust him for forgiveness. Turning away from sin and pleasing God begins in our hearts. The Holy Spirit gives those who belong to Jesus the power to say no to doing the wrong thing and the power to trust and obey God.**

Let's Do



Foster discipleship at home through a variety of flexible resources, including Let's Do and Family Talk for phones

Distribute *Let's Do 10,* pencils, and crayons. Have the children open their papers and lead them in doing the activities inside. In *What Did Adam and Eve Do?* children will recall that Adam and Eve disobeyed God. God found them when they hid and told them their lives would be hard. In *God Reached Out in Love,* children will be reminded that God showed mercy to Adam and Eve in two ways.

5 FINAL FOCUS

5 minutes

Gather the children in a circle around you. *Point out that* **When Adam and Eve sinned, they tried to hide from God.** *Ask* **Can you think of a time when you felt like hiding or leaving the room because you had done something wrong?** Listen as the children respond. Explain that we often feel uncomfortable and guilty when we have done something wrong. Point out that just as Adam and Eve sinned and felt guilty, we too may feel that way when we do the wrong thing or disobey.

God reached out in love to Adam and Eve, even after they had sinned against him. Even though Adam and Eve disobeyed God, he did not stop loving them. God reaches out to us in love, too. When we trust Jesus, the promised Savior, to save us from our sins, God forgives us our sin. He takes away our guilt and makes us clean inside.

Things to send home

- ☐ **SA 10 Adam & Eve puppet**
- ☐ ***Let's Do 10***

Lead the children in saying a prayer of trust. Ask them to close their eyes and repeat each phrase or sentence after you.

> **Dear God, thank you for your plan to save me.**
> **Thank you for sending Jesus to be my Savior.**
> **Please forgive my sins.**
> **Help me to trust and obey you. In Jesus' name, Amen.**

Close lesson with prayer, praise, songs, and Scripture verses to reinforce the Bible truth

Whisper this closing thought to each child as he or she leaves—"Jesus made things right for you."

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